

Day 91 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Geography of India (7): The Delhi-Dehradun Expressway & India's Expressway Network

READING MATERIAL

Covers the newly inaugurated Delhi-Dehradun Expressway and the broader status of India's expressway network.

Q: When was the Delhi-Dehradun Expressway inaugurated, and by whom?

A: 14 April 2026, by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Q: How long is the Delhi-Dehradun Expressway, and how much does it reduce travel time to?

A: 210 km, reducing Delhi-Dehradun travel time to just 2.5 hours.

Q: What are some key engineering features of the Delhi-Dehradun Expressway?

A: 6 entry/exit points, 113 underpasses, 76 km of service roads, 29 km of elevated highways, 5 Road-Over-Bridges (ROBs), and 62 bus shelters.

Q: As of April 2026, what is the total length of India's completed expressway network, and how much more is under construction?

A: 7,332 km completed; 11,127.69 km under construction.

Q: What is the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway, and what will it achieve once fully complete?

A: India's most ambitious road project — 1,350 km, costing ₹1,00,000 crore — which will cut Delhi-Mumbai travel time from ~24 hours to just 12 hours once fully complete (partially opened in phases since 2023).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Delhi-Dehradun Expressway was inaugurated on:

A. 14 February 2026

B. 14 March 2026

C. 14 April 2026 ✓

D. 14 May 2026

Explanation: 14 April 2026. [medium, web-research]

2. The Delhi-Dehradun Expressway is approximately how long, and reduces travel time to:

A. 150 km, 2 hours

B. 210 km, 2.5 hours ✓

C. 280 km, 4 hours

D. 350 km, 5 hours

Explanation: 210 km, 2.5 hours. [medium, web-research]

3. As of April 2026, India's total COMPLETED expressway network length is approximately:

A. 5,332 km

B. 6,332 km

C. 7,332 km ✓

D. 9,332 km

Explanation: 7,332 km. [hard, web-research]

4. The Delhi-Mumbai Expressway, India's most ambitious road project, is approximately how long?

A. 850 km

B. 1,050 km

C. 1,350 km ✓

D. 1,650 km

Explanation: 1,350 km. [medium, web-research]

5. Once fully complete, the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway will cut travel time from ~24 hours to:

A. 8 hours

B. 10 hours

C. 12 hours ✓

D. 15 hours

Explanation: 12 hours. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Logical Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Logical Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills (Part B Unit II, 10 questions total for the whole unit). Real exam evidence shows TNPSC's 'logical reasoning' label covers a wide variety of puzzle types, not just classic syllogisms — expect position-counting, ranking-from-clues, and direction-sense questions under this same heading too.

Q: Method — syllogism (statements → which conclusions necessarily follow): Statements: 'Some pens are books. All books are rods.' Conclusions: I. All pens are rods. II. Some pens are rods. III. Some books are pens. IV. All rods are pens. Which conclusions follow?

A: Only II and III follow. 'Some pens are books' + 'All books are rods' guarantees that AT LEAST SOME pens are rods (II) and that some books are indeed pens (III, since 'some pens are books' can be reversed to 'some books are pens'). It does NOT guarantee ALL pens are rods (I — only the 'some' pens that are books are guaranteed to be rods) or that ALL rods are pens (IV — nothing says rods can't include non-pen things).

Q: Method — position-in-a-line counting: Richard is 15th from the front in a column of boys. There are three times as many boys behind him as in front. How many boys are between Richard and the 7th boy from the end?

A: In front of Richard: 14 boys. Behind him: $3 \times 14 = 42$ boys. Total boys = $14 + 1 + 42 = 57$. The 7th from the end is at position $57 - 7 + 1 = 51$ from the front. Richard is at position 15. Boys between them = $51 - 15 - 1 = 35$.

Q: Method — algebraic word problem framed as a 'logical' puzzle: 106 trees were planted; non-fruit-bearing trees were 2 more than thrice the fruit-bearing trees. How many fruit-bearing trees were planted?

A: Let fruit-bearing = x . Non-fruit-bearing = $3x + 2$. Total: $x + 3x + 2 = 106 \rightarrow 4x = 104 \rightarrow x = 26$.

Q: Method — ranking from multiple comparative clues: Given several statements comparing four people's scores (e.g., 'Rama scored more than Rani but less than Rathna...'), determine who scored highest.

A: Work through each comparative clue methodically, building a single ordered chain (e.g., Rathna > Rama > Ramya > Rani), rather than trying to hold all comparisons in your head at once — write the partial order down step by step as each clue is read.

Q: Method — meaningful word sequencing: Arrange in a logical sequence: Honey, Flower, Bee, Wax.

A: Flower → Bee → Honey → Wax. The logic: a bee visits a Flower, produces Honey, and the Honey-making process also yields Wax (beeswax) — order reflects the natural/causal sequence of the process, not alphabetical or arbitrary order.

Q: Method — direction sense: A person starts walking, turns left, then turns left again, and is now heading East. Which direction did they originally start in?

A: West. Two consecutive left turns reverse the original direction (left+left = 180° turn), so if they end up heading East, they must have started heading West.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Statements: 'Some doctors are teachers. All teachers are readers.' Conclusions: I. Some doctors are readers. II. All doctors are readers. III. Some readers are teachers. Which follow?

A. Only I and III ✓

B. Only II

C. All three

D. None

Explanation: I and III follow the same logic as the worked example (some doctors are guaranteed readers via the teacher link; some readers are guaranteed teachers by reversing 'some'). II overreaches — not ALL doctors are teachers, so not all are guaranteed readers. [hard, authored]

2. In a column of boys, Meena is 10th from the front, and there are twice as many boys behind her as in front. How many boys are in the column in total?

A. 27

B. 28 ✓

C. 29

D. 30

Explanation: In front: 9. Behind: $2 \times 9 = 18$. Total = $9 + 1 + 18 = 28$. [medium, authored]

3. A farmer planted 84 saplings in total. The number of flowering saplings was 3 more than twice the number of non-flowering saplings. How many non-flowering saplings were planted?

A. 25

B. 27 ✓

C. 29

D. 31

Explanation: Let non-flowering=x. Flowering=2x+3. Total: $x+2x+3=84 \rightarrow 3x=81 \rightarrow x=27$. [medium, authored]

4. Arrange in a logical sequence: Seed, Tree, Fruit, Sapling.

A. Seed-Sapling-Tree-Fruit ✓

B. Seed-Tree-Sapling-Fruit

C. Sapling-Seed-Tree-Fruit

D. Seed-Fruit-Sapling-Tree

Explanation: A Seed grows into a Sapling, which matures into a Tree, which eventually bears Fruit. [easy, authored]

5. A person walks north, turns right, walks on, then turns right again. Which direction are they now facing?

A. North

B. South ✓

C. East

D. West

Explanation: Two consecutive right turns reverse the original direction: North $\rightarrow$ (right) East $\rightarrow$ (right) South. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "The Listeners" — Walter de la Mare

READING MATERIAL

A famously eerie, mysterious poem about a Traveller who knocks at a lone house's moonlit door, calls out, and gets no answer — except from unseen 'phantom listeners'. Real coaching-site evidence tests plot, atmosphere/tone, and figure-of-speech on specific lines.

Q: What happens in "The Listeners"?

A: A Traveller knocks on the door of a lone house at night (moonlit setting) and calls out 'Is there anybody there?' No human answers, but the house is full of unseen 'phantom listeners' who hear him. Perplexed that no one answers, the Traveller eventually leaves.

Q: What is the overall tone and setting of the poem?

A: Mysterious and eerie tone, set in a moonlit, silent, forest-adjacent house at night — atmosphere is the poem's central achievement.

Q: What does the phrase "phantom listeners" use as a figure of speech?

A: Personification — listeners that are 'phantom' (not physically present/human) are nonetheless given the human act of listening.

Q: What does "His horse in the silence champed the grasses" suggest, atmospherically?

A: That the silence is so deep that even a small, ordinary sound (a horse chewing grass) becomes noticeable — emphasizing just how quiet and still the setting is.

Q: Identify the figure of speech in "leaf-fringed sill."

A: Alliteration — repeated 'f' sound in 'leaf-fringed'.

Q: Why is the Traveller described as "perplexed"?

A: Because no one answers his call, despite the house seeming to be 'full' of listeners (the phantom listeners hear him, but don't respond).

Q: What does "Is there anybody there?" symbolize/express?

A: A desire for connection/contact — the Traveller's call represents a basic human wish to be heard and answered.

Q: What does the 'moonlit door' contribute to the poem?

A: Mystery and atmosphere — the moonlight visually sets the eerie, dreamlike, uncertain mood of the whole scene.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Listeners" was written by:

- A. William Wordsworth
- B. Robert Frost
- C. Walter de la Mare ✓**
- D. Sarojini Naidu

Explanation: Walter de la Mare. [easy, web-research]

2. What is the Traveller doing at the start of the poem?

- A. Escaping a war
- B. Searching for food
- C. Knocking on a door ✓**
- D. Singing in the woods

Explanation: Knocking on the door of a lone house. [easy, web-research]

3. Who actually hears the Traveller's call, per the poem?

- A. The villagers
- B. His horse
- C. Phantom listeners ✓**
- D. Birds

Explanation: Phantom listeners — unseen presences inside the house. [medium, web-research]

4. "Phantom listeners" is an example of which figure of speech?

- A. Metaphor
- B. Simile

C. Personification ✓

D. Alliteration

Explanation: Personification — non-human/unseen presences given the human act of listening. [medium, web-research]

5. "His horse in the silence champed the grasses" suggests:

A. The horse is wild

B. Nature is loud

C. The silence is so deep that small sounds are noticeable ✓

D. The horse is tired

Explanation: Emphasizes the depth of the surrounding silence. [medium, web-research]

6. "Leaf-fringed sill" is an example of:

A. Simile

B. Alliteration ✓

C. Irony

D. Metaphor

Explanation: Alliteration — repeated 'f' sound. [medium, web-research]

7. The overall tone of "The Listeners" is best described as:

A. Joyful

B. Mysterious and eerie ✓

C. Romantic

D. Humorous

Explanation: Mysterious and eerie. [easy, web-research]

8. Why is the Traveller "perplexed" in the poem?

A. He sees a ghost directly

B. No one answers his call ✓

C. His horse runs away

D. He's lost his way

Explanation: No one answers, despite the house seemingly being occupied. [medium, web-research]